BRIAN MBUTHIA NJUGUNA

Customer Service & CX Team Lead | Support Operations | Fintech | Remote or Nairobi

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Customer Service Team Lead with 5.5 years in fintech at Branch International, a regulated microfinance bank, growing from frontline agent to leading a fully remote team of 13 across Kenya, Tanzania and 7 channels. Runs teams against clear KPIs (QA, CSAT, first response time, first contact resolution, SLA), coaches through regular 1:1s, builds training and QA programs, and acts as the escalation point for fraud, KYC, complaints and data protection cases. Finds what drives contacts and fixes it with Product, Engineering, Risk and Compliance, and uses AI to improve service. Available to work any hours, in any time zone.

CORE SKILLS

- **Team Leadership:** Supervising and mentoring remote teams, 1:1s, coaching and feedback, performance management, recognition programs, scheduling, PTO and leave approvals
- **Training & QA:** Training program design, onboarding, cross-training, merchant training, Training of Trainers (certified), QA programs and rubrics, interaction evaluations
- **KPIs & Data:** QA, CSAT, DSAT, first response time, first contact resolution, SLA, AHT, backlog; dashboards, SQL, Advanced Excel, Google Sheets, Metabase, weekly reporting
- **Escalations & Compliance:** Escalation and complaints handling, fraud and KYC cases, data protection (DPO) requests, CRB clearance, audit-ready documentation, regulated financial services
- **Process & AI:** Contact driver analysis, root cause fixes, process optimization, SOPs and knowledge bases, AI call notes, Gemini for reporting, chatbot expansion, NLP sentiment analysis
- **Tools:** Zendesk (5+ years), Mteja CRM, CallTools, Typeform, Salesforce (familiar), Slack, Zoom

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Customer Satisfaction:** CSAT up 22 points (33% to 55%) by finding the highest-friction point in the customer journey and redesigning the resolution process.
- **Response Time:** First response time down 67% (90 to 30 minutes) through better ticket routing and standard shift handoffs.
- **Contact Drivers:** About 3,000 fewer tickets a week after identifying account merge as a top contact driver and fixing the root cause with Product and Engineering.
- **Quality & Resolution:** Steady 90% QA score and 85%+ SLA adherence across a team of 13; first contact resolution up 18% through the knowledge base, playbooks and FAQs.
- **Training & People:** New hire ramp-up time halved with a structured 2-week onboarding program; 2 agents promoted to senior roles within 2 years; overtime costs down 30%.
- **AI & Efficiency:** Call handling time down 60% (5 to 2 minutes) with an AI call notes integration; weekly reporting cut from 3 to 4 hours to about 1 with Gemini.
- **Product & Risk:** Customer-impacting product issues down 40%; Google Play rating up from 4.2 to 4.5 after a self-service PIN reset backed by analysis I helped conduct; fraud rates down 12%.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Branch International | Fintech / Microfinance Bank | Jul 2020 - Jan 2026

Customer Service Team Lead | Branch International | May 2024 - Jan 2026

- **Team Leadership & Development:** Supervised and mentored a fully remote team of 13 advisors in Kenya and Tanzania across 7 channels (in-app, email, SMS, phone, WhatsApp, Facebook, Twitter); held biweekly 1:1s using QA reports, built individual development plans, ran a weekly scorecard and monthly recognition, and promoted 2 agents to senior roles within 2 years.
- **Scheduling & Coverage:** Approved schedule changes, shift swaps, PTO and leave only after checking coverage, spot-checked schedule adherence through live monitoring, and tracked overtime, cutting overtime costs by 30% while holding 85%+ SLA adherence.
- **Onboarding & Training:** Designed a 2-week onboarding program with a buddy system and stepped message targets that halved new hire ramp-up time; cross-trained the team on every channel, ran targeted training from weekly QA breakdowns, and trained around 60 merchants during the Lipa na Branch campaign.
- **Quality Assurance:** Built QA rubrics and maintained a 90% team QA score, using weekly breakdowns of issue types per advisor (auto-fail and non-auto-fail) to close performance gaps.
- **Escalations & Complaints:** Primary escalation point for complex and sensitive cases; checked escalation queues hourly, filed bug reports with Engineering (KYC, Payments, Android) until resolved, and handled fraud claims, frozen wallets, account merge cases, CRB clearance, data deletion and DPO requests.
- **Fraud Escalation:** Designed a Rapid Fraud Escalation Framework with prefilled templates and dedicated routing (target: fraud escalated within 2 minutes, complaints resolved within 24 hours).
- **KPIs & Reporting:** Monitored QA, CSAT, first response time, AHT and backlog daily in Zendesk and Mteja CRM; prepared the weekly CS report from Metabase, Zendesk and Mteja data, cut from 3 to 4 hours to about 1 with Gemini.
- **Contact Drivers & Process:** Fixed the root cause of repeat account merge contacts with Product and Engineering, removing about 3,000 tickets a week; redesigned routing and shift handoffs (first response time down 67%) and the resolution process (CSAT 33% to 55%).
- **Documentation:** Built SOPs, tiered escalation frameworks, playbooks, FAQs and the knowledge base (FCR up 18%) with the QA, Fraud and Payment Ops teams.
- **Cross-team Collaboration:** Worked with Product, Engineering, Data, Risk, Compliance, Credit and Marketing on proactive service alerts, KYC simplification, CRB automation and loan limits, reducing customer-impacting product issues by 40%.
- **Product Launch:** Researched competitor pricing for an MPesa float purchase feature and presented it to leadership; at launch, trained the whole company on the product and set up a dedicated merchant support queue. The product went on to process about KES 3 to 5 million a week.
- **AI to Improve CSAT:** Coordinated an AI call notes integration (AHT down 60%), supported chatbot expansion, and developed an NLP sentiment analysis proposal with the QA team linking sentiment to CSAT and FCR.
- **Customer Feedback:** Monitored Google Play reviews weekly, covered social media and TikTok DMs, and helped conduct the analysis behind self-service PIN reset; the Google Play rating rose from 4.2 to 4.5 after rollout.
- **Strategy:** Wrote the 2026 CS Department Strategy (retention, cost optimization, product trust), including a workforce management system targeting shrinkage from 26% to under 15%, and designed a customer recovery program (targets: 60% win-back, 15% churn reduction).

Customer Service Senior Associate | Branch International | May 2023 - Apr 2024

- **Efficiency:** Improved team efficiency by 15% (tickets resolved per agent per hour) by standardizing response processes and best-practice guides.
- **Reporting:** Built SQL and Advanced Excel dashboards used by senior management for weekly staffing and SLA decisions.
- **Voice of Customer:** Shared customer insights that led to workflow improvements adopted by the Product team.
- **Coverage:** Managed daily coverage and shift scheduling, keeping SLA on track during high-volume periods.

Loan Review Associate | Branch International | Jan 2023 - Apr 2023

- **KYC Accuracy:** Verified 200+ loan applications a day with zero KYC errors, confirmed by compliance audit.
- **Fraud Prevention:** Spotted recurring fraud patterns and improved the process, cutting fraud rates by 12%.

Customer Service Associate | Branch International | Jul 2020 - Dec 2022

- **Multi-channel Support:** Supported customers across 5 channels and handled complaints, account and payment issues.
- **Knowledge Base:** Built and maintained a knowledge base for common questions, improving first-contact resolution.
- **Cross-team Work:** Worked with IT, Finance and Risk to resolve complex customer issues.

EDUCATION

- BSc Information Technology, Multimedia University of Kenya, 2014 - 2018

CERTIFICATIONS

- Team Management & Leadership Certification, LinkedIn Learning, 2025
- Training of Trainers (ToT) Certification, 2024
- Data Privacy & Cybersecurity Awareness Training, 2023, 2025
- Certified Customer Experience Professional (CCXP), CXPA, in progress, 2026

LANGUAGES

- English (fluent, excellent verbal and written communication) | Kiswahili (fluent)